MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Friday, February 13, 2026

Date	Friday, February 13, 2026
Place	Senate of Virginia, Senate Chamber, State Capitol, Richmond
Length	3h 47m (video)

- Official floor video (Senate of Virginia, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mE-0QVidhYg
- LIS Senate minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/S

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-18. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:28] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:00:35] Senate chamber.

[00:02:45] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:04:01] Senate chamber.

[00:04:38] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:05:48] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:06:54] Chamber.

[00:07:54] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:09:57] Senate Chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings,

[00:12:04] and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:12:27] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. Chamber. The Senate of Virginia,

[00:16:17] Richmond, Virginia. Senate Chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions,

[00:18:23] catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's

[00:18:28] YouTube channel. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. Senate chamber. This is the

[00:22:36] Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. Senate chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live

[00:24:43] sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of

[00:24:49] Virginia's YouTube channel. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. Chamber. This is

[00:28:57] the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. Senate chamber. Senate will come to order. The senators

[00:31:00] will please take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able. We will be led in prayer today by the Reverend Dr. Derwin Hickman, Sr. from Divine World Changers International Ministries in Richmond and following the prayer everyone will please remain standing and be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Max Davis of Charlottesville. Lieutenant

[00:31:35] Governor and Senate floor let us pray. Our Father the Creator of all we come before you today as representatives of the people seeking your guidance and wisdom as we convene. We acknowledge our sovereignty over the nations and the importance of justice, righteousness, moral responsibilities, social cohesion, and shared accountability. We lift up every bill that will come before this floor.

[00:32:02] Let our hearts be united in one accord, transcending color and division as we work for common good. May our discussions today be filled with with understanding and respect for one another as we show the love of the Father.

[00:32:18] We recognize the essential nature, unity among us, how good and pleasant it is when God's people live together in unity. May we set aside our differences and work in harmony for together we can do so many things.

[00:32:35] So Father, we ask right now that you will cover us and that you will cover every decision and that we will put aside selfish motives and that we will work on the behalf of those that we are serving in legislation. May we sign bills that will lift up and not tear down.

[00:32:52] May we unite in love and may we remember the purpose of why we are here. We are here to serve. We are here to bring hope and to bring life. May we spread and walk in love at all times. May our words be uplifting and not tearing down one another.

[00:33:11] It is not about the parties. It is about the lives that we represent and how we live is what it is important. So help us to serve and to do that in which we've been called to do. We ask that your spirit rests here, is in the name that's above every other name.

[00:33:27] Amen. - I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, One nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:34:06] The clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye.

[00:34:28] The clerk will close the roll. You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Thursday, February 12, 2026. The senator from King George moves that the reading of the journal be

waived.

[00:34:52] All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:35:11] Ayes 34, noes 4. Ayes 34, noes 4. The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communication from the House of Delegates. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Good morning, Madam President. Good morning.

[00:35:28] Glad we were able to get that journal waived last time. Madam President, I would move to waive reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes, aye.

[00:35:44] Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 34, noes 5.

[00:36:00] Ayes 34, noes 5. The reading of the journal is waived. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor. - We do not have any, Madam President. - We've now arrived in the time of the morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us today in our gallery.

[00:36:24] I give my daily reminder about our procedure that a senator will rise and provide an introduction for their visitors. I will then offer the welcome of the Senate and I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to provide the Senate's welcome.

[00:36:41] The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, Dr. Reverend Hickman does not need an introduction because he's been here before and we all know him, but if you please rise.

[00:36:58] Dr. Reverend Hickman is a senior pastor, Divine World Changers International Ministries, a ministry with a vision of transforming lives with the love, heart, and mind of God. And I'll just say, if you're ever in town on a Sunday, you should go because he brings the heat in a sermon. All right. But I think the really beautiful thing about his church and his ministry is about how much work they do in the region for our community, whether it's for kids, for folks in trouble.

[00:37:24] You know, he's working 24-7 to make our community a better place. And as a result, Richmond's a stronger community. And so I hope we give them a strong, warm Senate welcome. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and thank you, Reverend, for providing such powerful prayers and words of blessing this morning.

[00:37:44] We are so thankful to you for joining us today in the Senate chamber. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Reverend Dr. Derwin Hickman, Sr. from Richmond. The chair recognizes the senator from TASWA.

[00:38:06] Thank you, Madam President. I rise to ask that the Senate journal reflect the absence of my seatmate, the senator from Shenandoah, that is a way of pressing personal business.

[00:38:21] The journal will so reflect. The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. Good morning, Madam President. Good morning. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I rise today to recognize Shreya and Asha Venkat, if they would rise.

[00:38:39] Two extraordinary young leaders from Loudoun County who are celebrating the 10th anniversary of their non-profit Nest For Us. What began a decade ago as a simple goal to help those in need has grown into a global movement of over 9,000 volunteers. Nest For Us has served over 350,000 meals and rescued 4 million pounds of food, contributing more than $6.5 million in volunteer value to our communities.

[00:39:05] Their dedication has earned them national honors from the Points of Light Award to the Governor's Outstanding Youth Volunteer Award and even led Dominion Trail Elementary in Ashburn to name the Venkat House in their honor. Shreya and Eshisha represent the very best of the 32nd District, proving that small acts of compassion and determined action in our local communities can truly change the world.

[00:39:28] Madam President, I ask my colleagues to join me in congratulating Nest Forest on 10 years of extraordinary surveys and extend the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And 10 years is a long time. So you must have started when you were very little and what extraordinary achievements that you have been able to perform.

[00:39:51] You have served so many in the community. So we certainly thank you, Shreya and Esha, for all that you are doing. inspiring so many other young people to follow your example for community service. So very inspiring work. And see that you've brought some other guests with you. Are those your parents? And if they too would stand, we would love to acknowledge and not just Shreya and Esha Venkat, but also mom and dad who have, of course, been their first mentors. Senators, I ask that we give the warm

[00:40:26] welcome of the senate to shreya and esha venkat is there any other business for the morning hour the clerk will call the calendar senate calendar for friday february 13th 2026 unfinished business

[00:40:58] senate senate joint resolution 60. the junior senator from virginia beach good morning madam president madam president i move that the senate concur with the house for what do you rise i'm I'm sorry, Madam President, I rise to speak to the resolution.

[00:41:24] The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Senate concur with the House Amendment and speak to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. SJ60 was part of Governor Spanberger's appointments, and this is just a technical amendment in nature.

[00:41:45] Thank you, Madam President. And I move that it pass. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the amendment proposed by the House of Delegates? All in favor of concurring with the amendments will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[00:42:01] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, noes 0. Ayes 37, noes 0.

[00:42:18] The Senate concurs with the amendments proposed by the House of Delegates. uncontested calendar senate bills on third reading the senator from eastern fairfax thank you madam president um i move that the senate bills on third reading uncontested calendar on pages 2 through 17 senate bills 128 through senate bill 823 be placed on their final passage in the block any senator desiring to remove the bill

from the block please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill and madam president speaking to that motion senator has

[00:42:57] the floor thank you madam president ladies and gentlemen i meant to do this as an announcement at the beginning, but this motion right now is ordinary course. We're also going to take all the bills on uncontested second read all the way through to final passage today, so keep that in mind. Also, you should see you have a supplemental calendar in front of you, which represents, I think, the bills that were taken up in finance last night. I believe you will also see an additional supplemental calendar in a little bit relating to the four bills that were heard in rehab this morning. So just be aware of that. Want to make sure everybody knew what's going on. But right now

[00:43:34] we got to take up stuff in the ordinary course. The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested calendar, third reading, pages 2 through 17, Senate Bill 128 through Senate Bill 823, be placed on their final passage in a block with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the

[00:44:10] number of the bills. Senate Bill 128, Senate Bill 3, Senate Bill 5, Senate Bill 20, Senate Bill 33, Senate Bill 25, Senate Bill 112, Senate Bill 125, Senate

[00:44:42] bill 134 Senate bill 138 Senate bill 197 Senate bill 280 Senate bill 345 Senate bill 399 Senate bill 447 Senate bill 450 Senate bill 487 Senate bill 499

[00:45:11] Senate bill 505 Senate bill 516 Senate bill 527 Senate bill 530 Senate bill 680 Senate bill 767 Senate bill 823 the question is shall the bills in the block now pass all in favor of the passage of the bills will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do

[00:45:47] any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role ayes 39 ayes 39 noes 0 the bills in the block pass regular calendar Senate bills on third reading Senate bill 305 a bill relating to kinship foster care barrier crime waiver reported from the committee on rehabilitation and social services with amendments and there's one floor amendment the senator from Western Fairfax madam president can this go by momentarily we're waiting for a floor amendment that hasn't made its way without objection Senate bill 305 goes

[00:46:26] by temporarily. Senate Bill 643, a bill relating to firearm purchase requirements penalties reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Can I go by temporarily please? Without objection, Senate Bill 643 goes by temporarily. Senate Bill 83, a bill relating to security policies for courthouses and local or national or

[00:47:01] regional correctional facilities penalty. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. I move that the bill passed. I'm speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Senate bill 83 is this is the courthouse access bill that deals with allowing cell phones inside the courthouses allowing the attorney with proper credentials to bypass security and of course requiring a means of confidential communication between lawyers and their clients in our local jails as well and with that I hope that

[00:47:33] we pass this bill the question is shall Senate bill 83 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators

desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 26 knows 13 eyes 26 knows 13 Senate bill

[00:48:06] 83 passes Senate bill 84 a bill relating to speed safety cameras placement and operation violation enforcement civil penalties report senator from Norfolk madam president I moved that the bill passed and speaking to the bill senator has the floor thank you madam president SB 84 is focused on improving safety in in the places where Virginians are most vulnerable school crossing zones work zones and clearly documented high-risk speed corridors it is about preventing

[00:48:44] crashes before they happen the bill authorizes speed safety cameras pedestrian crossing violation monitoring systems and stop sign violation monitoring systems in a oh wait I'm sorry madam president can we pass by this temporarily without objection Senate bill 84 will go by temporarily

[00:49:06] internet gaming authorized report senator from Hampton thank you madam president I move to Senate bill 118 passed by for the day without objection Senate bill 118 goes by for the day Senate bill 129 a bill to direct the Virginia Lottery in the Virginia Department of Agriculture and Consumer

[00:49:45] Services to assess the regulation and taxation of fantasy contests in the commonwealth report senator from alexandria i move the bill passed and speaking to that motion the senator has the floor as this bill stands now it's a study of how we should um regulate fantasy uh contests being fantasy football leagues that sort of thing this contrary to what you might have heard in the news media the original bill did not affect if you play with your friends and and don't use a internet platform to a large company

[00:50:23] to facilitate your league. There was no tax in consumers ever contemplated. But this bill has no fiscal impact, no tax. It's just a study about closing the loophole, betting against the House, and people who are really doing sports betting, saying that it's fantasy leagues.

[00:50:42] But it'll be a study, and we'll get a report so that next year there can be a bill that we can build consensus behind. And again, I move it passed. The senator from Orange. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking of the bill. Senator has the floor.

[00:50:58] Madam President, I appreciate what the senator said about the bill and being changed to a study. But the truth is, this type of gaming came on our radar late in the study on the commission. We found out they were paying no taxes at all since they've been here.

[00:51:17] And the original bill was trying to make the age 21, which I think at some point we need to get there because all other forms of gaming, and I'm sure that's gonna bore itself out in the study. But I would tell everybody, you're not voting to raise taxes on this. You're just voting to get this bill to a study. I appreciate everybody's support.

[00:51:36] - The question is, shall Senate Bill 129 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:51:57] Ayes 29, Nose 10. Ayes 29, Nose 10. Senate Bill 129 passes. Senate Bill 162. Relating to voter registration, restoration of political rights upon release from incarceration, certain adjudications.

[00:52:18] The senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move the Senate Bill 162 pass and speak into that. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 162 is the enabling legislation that supports Senate Joint Resolution 2, the constitutional amendment regarding the restoration of rights.

[00:52:35] Again, I move the Senate Bill 162 pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 162 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[00:52:52] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. - Ayes 21, noes 18, Senate Bill 162 passes. - Senate Bill 175, a bill relating to electric utilities, renewable energy portfolio standard program requirements, power purchase agreements.

[00:53:19] - Senator from Western Henrico. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. - The Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, Senate Bill 175 is a bill that we saw last year and picked up bipartisan support around putting solar where everybody agrees it should go. If you remember in 2020, the Clean Economy Act created a 1% carve out for distributed solar projects within the RPS and a 200 megawatts for projects on previously developed sites like commercial and industrial sites, brownfields, landfills, parking lots, et cetera.

[00:53:50] This bill moves that 1% eventually up to 5% and then puts it at the will of the SEC. It moves the 200 megawatts to 1,000 megawatts for those previously built out sites, and it extends the undergrounding program for years.

[00:54:08] This gets more solar in the places we all want it to go, like my neighborhoods, and so I would hope we would vote for Senate Bill 175. The question is, shall Senate Bill 175 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[00:54:24] Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:54:41] Ayes 23, noes 16. Ayes 23, noes 16. Senate Bill 175 passes. Senate Bill 180, a bill relating to fines and costs, period of limitations on collection.

[00:54:57] Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for a motion. Senator has the floor. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. SB 180, which is before the body, is the product of a substitute that consolidates prior policy concepts into one comprehensive and balanced reform of court debt collection.

[00:55:20] This legislation is about proportionality, finality, and responsible reentry. First, the bill as substituted establishes a clear 10-year statute of limitations for collection of court imposed fines, costs, forfeitures, and penalties. Under court law, some court debt can follow a person for decades, in certain cases up to 60 years. That is not proportional to the underlying offense that often gives rise to these obligations. This bill provides certainty. After 10 years, the debt

[00:55:54] cannot be revived, restarted, or extended by making a partial payment or by changing the collection method. Accountability should be real, but not live in perpetuity. Second, the bill substitutes modernizes the collection timeline. It extends the referral period from, I'm sorry, yeah, it extends the referral period from 90 days to 180 days, giving individuals additional time to enter payment arrangements before accounts are reported delinquent or sent to collections. Third and most critically the bill ensures that no

[00:56:33] collection activity may occur while an individual is incarcerated and subject to a deferred payment agreement. We should not be initiating collection actions when someone has no meaningful earning capacity. For those sentenced to act to active incarceration the court must establish a deferred payment agreement with payments not due until at least 180 days after release. That six-month runway supports stability during re-entry, recurring housing, securing housing, employment, transportation, and reconnecting with family.

[00:57:12] The bill does not erase debt, it does not remove accountability, and it has no bearing restitution. It creates structure, predictability, and dignity in the process. Stable reentry strengthens families, predictable systems increase compliance, and fair timelines reduce recidivism. SB 180 reflects balance and accountability, firm, fair, and final. Madam President, I renew my motion that the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate bill 180 pass? All in favor of

[00:57:51] that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 22 no 17 ayes 22 no 17 Senate bill 180 passes Senate bill 219 a bill relating to photo speed monitoring devices summons reports. The Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the bill pass and speaking to

[00:58:27] that bill. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, thank you. Senate Bill 219 simply requires that a second notice be given for traffic violations where the devices are being used as well. If there is a mailed summons, it does not count as a criminal conviction or affect driving records or insurance. The bill also requires warning signs, allows drivers to review evidence, and provide ways to contest violations. Madam President, I renew my motion for the bill to pass.

[00:58:59] The question is, shall Senate Bill 219 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37 noes 2. Ayes 37 noes

[00:59:34] 2. Senate bill 219 passes. Senate bill 249. A bill relating to electric utilities integrated resource plans platts state corporation commission commission on electric utility regulation work group report. Senator from eastern Fairfax. Thank you madam president. I move the bill pass and speaking to that motion.

[00:59:59] The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. In advance, I just want to thank the Chairman of Commerce and Labor for docketing all my bills at once so that seven of the next ten bills are mine. Madam President, Senate Bill 249 is legislation that you all approved last year.

[01:00:18] It was ultimately vetoed by the Governor. It has to do with integrated resource plans with a couple additional things. The CER looked at it over the year and added a couple more things to it. but the bill was a recommendation of the Commission on Electrical Utility Regulation. The idea was to, yes, both reduce and consolidate the number of things we do in an IRP.

[01:00:37] In the IRP every year, there's a CONACMA clause that directs the SEC to do that. In addition, though, the bill also requires utilities to pick their preferred mix of energy sources that comply with the VCEA and still look at least case scenarios during planning.

[01:00:55] It also requires Appalachian Power to start doing IRPs again. They were relieved from that I think four or five years ago. It also requires, it eases the need to do IRPs to three years instead of one every

two years. So they're not doing it as often.

[01:01:12] Utilities also don't have to submit RPS plans the year after they submit an IRP. At least once every five years, the SEC has to look at eliminating things that aren't needed anymore. The bill also strengthens the stakeholder process by requiring more stakeholder engagement.

[01:01:28] using a third-party facilitator to try to limit the matters that are fought about in irp plans one of the things that's new is it requires utilities to evaluate and propose using surplus interconnection which i think is something a couple other members have bills on this session so that we don't have to have new sites for generation the bill also requires us to look at transmission as part of the irp process and not just generation the enactment clause is it requires sc to develop planning regulations based on the recommendation of a work group it also what's new and one other thing is new is it asks us to look at co-ops to figure out which co-ops

[01:02:04] ought to be included in the irp process because four of our co-ops are now going to be producing more or selling more electricity than apco given the growth of data centers in virginia that's basically what the bill does uh again it's largely the same as last year with a couple editions i hope you get passed the question is shall senate bill 249 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the

[01:02:40] senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. Senate bill 249 passes. Senate bill 250. A bill relating to electric utilities, small portable solar generation devices, residential landlord and tenant act. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill past and speak of that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate Bill 250 is an exciting new

[01:03:15] idea that comes to us from Europe called Balcony Solar. There's over a million of these panels that have been used by consumers in Germany. There's only one state in America so far that's authorized them. That's Utah. And Virginia, I hope, will be the second. You're going to see it actually pass a whole bunch more states this year i think but the idea is to allow people to basically get a a small solar panel not a whole array and to be able to hang it outside their house or their trailer or their business or whatever and plug it into a regular household utility outlet so they

[01:03:52] can mitigate some of the cost of electricity by producing some on their own the matter president if there ever was an affordability bill this is it because these things pay for themselves and allows people to save money on their electricity, especially if you live in an area where electricity is expensive.

[01:04:11] You get yourself a solar panel, plug it into your house. You don't need to go out and get a permit, waste a bunch of time with the government trying to get permission to do it. This gives it to you. As a matter of present, I would hope we would let Virginians generate their own electricity easily, efficiently, affordably, and save themselves some money.

[01:04:27] And I hope we could pass this bill. The senior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. Will the gentleman from eastern Fairfax yield for a question? senator will you yield oh you the senator from virginia beach has the floor madam president i asked the uh gentleman if the power goes out what's going to prevent these devices from back feeding into the system now i know in the substitute bill it says that there's a requirement

[01:05:02] for the individual to have some kind of a device installed to prevent the back feeding but it it doesn't go into specifics so what specifically and how will it work for to prevent back feeding into the system when the power goes out senator from Eastern Fairfax madam president I would say that first of all while my my grandfather was the electrician who wired the star in Roanoke in 1948 my electric electrical skills not quite as good as his were but I'll note that the

[01:05:36] bill on lines 96 and 97 requires the device to have a feature that prevents it from affecting the electrical system of a building during a power outage. And so it cannot be sold in Virginia if it doesn't have that kind of a feature on it. The technical specifications of how it works, I don't know. But I would submit that given that a million of these have been installed in Germany, I would think that they were designed in a way not to cause those kinds of problems.

[01:06:04] Madam president speaking to the bill. The senator has the floor. Madam president I'm very familiar with these devices. I'm very familiar with the ones that have the solar panels and the battery backup. So the solar panel charges the battery backup and when the power goes out that battery backup actually powers the the house. The problem is if you don't walk over to the fuse panel and switch the master switch to off then it back feeds the system so if there's in

[01:06:40] an apartment building if you have one of these and it's charging a battery and it's feeding into your house system the only way to stop this from getting out onto the grid or out onto the wires where you'll have linemen trying to fix where there's a power outage is to physically walk over and shut your power to off which is the main feed there are automated ways to do this there's automatic ways to do this but they're very expensive they require an electrician to wire it into the panel which again most apartment buildings and most rental units will not allow

[01:07:19] so the only way to physically do that is you have to physically walk over put the breaker from on to off and then let the device go on otherwise you're going to back feed into the grid and madam president i'm going to vote against this because i've read this i've talked to two of the utilities and both of the utilities said that they're still trying to figure this out they haven't found a fix on this i think this is one that once this happens and one of our linemen get shocked and killed we're going to have a problem so i'm going to vote no on this to slow this down and if this gets corrected before it comes back to us i'm happy to vote yes but right

[01:07:58] now after talking to two of the utilities, they don't have a solution on the best way to do this or how to do this. Thank you. The question is, shall Senate Bill 250 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 30,

[01:08:31] no 7 rule 361 eyes 30 no 7 rule 361 senate bill 250 passes senate bill 251 a bill to direct the state corporation commission to evaluate electric utility performance in the commonwealth report senator from eastern fairfax thank you madam president i moved the bill passed and speaking to that motion the senator has the floor thank you madam president ladies and gentlemen senate this here is another affordability bill and what this bill does is another

[01:09:06] bill out of the Commission on Electrical Utility Regulation that's based on a bill that we passed about I guess three sessions ago now myself and Delegate Sullivan had to do with performance based regulation over the last two years the State Corporation Commission hired a consultant to look at how we regulate utilities to try and figure out if there were different ways to incentivize utilities to provide

electricity at a lower cost and they came out with a report we read that report analyzed it and based on that we directed the State Corporation Commission do a couple things that reflected in this bill and I think Senator Deeds has another one which has another sort of similar piece

[01:09:44] of this but the bill basically says that we ought to look at the SEC needs to come back and look at it tell us whether or not we can reduce the number of rate adjustment clauses we have and move that matters in those rate adjustment clauses back into base rates so that utilities maybe are not guaranteed as as much of a straight pass through on those on those costs number one number two it suggests that we ought to look at whether there are a way to share the risk on fuel costs right now fuel costs are passed straight through from the utility to consumers so the utility doesn't have any incentive to try to

[01:10:21] reduce fuel costs but if we shared that risk and they could maybe use other techniques to reduce risk on fuel costs. Maybe we could save some money to everybody on fuel costs. And the same thing on compliance costs for the Virginia Clean Economy Act. Right now those costs are required to be passed straight through, but if we could share risk on that, then perhaps the utilities have more incentive to try to comply faster to get those costs down to consumers. In addition, it suggests that we also investigate looking at all-source procurement, and what that means is that when the utility says they need to generate a certain amount of electricity, instead of saying

[01:10:56] they want to do it with either a solar farm or another wind farm or a gas plant they have to put out an RFP to the private sector to say why don't you propose how to produce that gigawatt or whatever of electricity and we'll look at whatever the lowest cost solution is instead of the utility deciding and then trying to get the SEC to approve it and litigating that. There's also a few other things in the bill but we expect to get a report back by the end of the year to have legislation to act on for next year. But if you are concerned about the cost of electricity, you need to vote green. If you don't care about the cost of electricity, go ahead and vote red. I hope we

[01:11:34] can pass the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 251 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, no 16. Ayes 23, no 16. Senate Bill 251 passes. Senate Bill 252 relating to renewable energy

[01:12:08] portfolio standard programs general geothermal heating and cooling systems report. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill passes. Speaking of that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate Bill 252 is a version of a bill that passed last year. It was vetoed by the governor for reasons I still don't understand.

[01:12:32] The bill basically is designed to jump start, turbo charge our geothermal heating and cooling industry. Basically, what it's designed to do is increase access to geothermal so that consumers can get the benefits of geothermal instead of having to be limited to things like heat pumps, furnaces, and air conditioning to heat and cool their homes or businesses.

[01:12:57] The bill basically creates a new market for renewable energy certificates for geothermal to the extent they reduce demand for energy on our electrical grid, which means that if you install a geothermal heat pump system, number one, by the way, the federal government will pay for a third of the cost.

[01:13:17] Another third, it also costs about three times more than a regular system, but when the federal government pays a third, you have to pay the other third anyway. the other third is paid for by the energy

savings of the project over about 10 years. If we add these renewable energy certificates to stream money to the equation, they're even more affordable.

[01:13:36] And they're doing this in Maryland. Maryland has a booming geothermal industry right now. There's all kinds of jobs in drilling and HVAC. Jobs don't require college degrees going on. And if we could do the same thing here, we could have those jobs in that industry here in Virginia and give people more choices how they want to create or heat and cool their homes and businesses and in the meantime we could save some energy so i hope we pass the bill the question is shall senate bill 252 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote

[01:14:11] have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role ayes 25 noes 14. ayes 25 noes 14. senate bill 252 passes. senate bill 254 a bill relating to electric utilities shared solar programs phase 2 utility. senator from eastern fairfax move the bill pass and speaking of that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president ladies gentlemen senate senate bill 254 and also 255 that's about to come up next are both shared

[01:14:46] solar bills or in some states they call community solar or solar gardens uh we first passed in this This bill relates to Dominion. The next bill has to do with APCO. Shared solar is basically the idea that a utility can build a small solar project, typically about 30 acres, and then take that energy and sell it to either homes or businesses to them so they can net that energy against their meter on their house or their business.

[01:15:14] That way, the home or business person doesn't have to do the upfront investment of building solar. You don't have to borrow a bunch of money to put it on your roof and go through all the permitting and everything else. just go to some company and say, I want to buy 5% off your panels, and they net it against your meter. We started this in 2020 in Virginia, and it was my bill back then, but the way it ended up playing out, because of an SCC ruling, all of the program ended up being eaten up by low-income customers for low-income housing. We amended it about two years ago, and the state corporation commission fixed the minimum bill, and we also grew the program.

[01:15:52] What this bill does is expands the program to, I think, 500 and some megawatts. And it adds another 200 megawatts to the program. It also limits low-income participation in a way that it won't cannibalize the program this time.

[01:16:09] And given the minimum bill the SEC adopted, it will minimize cost shifts to everybody else. But if you like solar, you should vote green on this bill. If you don't like utility solar, you should vote green on this bill. because these are much smaller projects. They're 30 acres each. They have much smaller footprint. They're much less vis-ly visual disruption, and it gives consumers a choice on who to buy their energy from in a small, very small, but meaningful way. I hope we can adopt the bill.

[01:16:41] The question is, shall Senate Bill 254 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? do any Senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:17:01] Ayes 24, noes 15. Ayes 24, noes 15. Senate bill 254 passes. Senate bill 255, a bill relating to electric utilities, shared solar programs, phase one utility. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that Senate bill 255 pass in speaking of that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate bill 255 is the same bill I just talked about except this is for apco

because it's apco it's a much smaller program the original program from apco was capped at 50 megawatts and did not have a low income uh low income program in it this bill expands it by

[01:17:41] another 50 megawatts um and by july 1 of 2026 and then another 50 megawatts on january 1 of 2028. it also um gets apco to fix their their the way they do it on their bill apco doesn't have didn't have the capacity to issue one bill to consumers, this going forward after this passes they will fix it so you only get one bill instead of two bills. But this also will give people in APCO territory a much better choice of getting shared solar where they didn't really have a lot

[01:18:20] of opportunities before because the program was so small. Hope we could pass this bill as well. the question is shall senate bill 255 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 23 no 16 ayes 23 no 16 senate bill

[01:18:53] 255 passes Senate bill 288 a bill relating to protection of employees standards for heat illness prevention senator from Eastern Henrico thank you madam president I move the bill move forward but I like to speak to them motion senator has the floor thank you so much madam president this legislation is relative to ensuring that individuals that have to work in outdoor warm temperatures have some level of protections but I wanted to highlight some of the significant changes that came as a result of the substitute so we

[01:19:32] took the entire framework and removed the private right of action for those workers we now eliminate the previous requirement to adopt an enforceable heat illness regulation on a very specific set timeline and we change it from asking the safety and health codes board to develop standards and now I'm just instead do regulations and we require an implementation plan with cost estimates before we could actually move forward with any of this.

[01:19:58] And so, I hope that we can move the legislation forward. The question is, shall Senate Bill 288 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[01:20:14] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. Senate Bill 288 passes.

[01:20:34] Senate Bill 327, a bill relating to Electric Utilities Pilot Program for Electric Energy Conservation, Generation, and Storage. The Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move passage of the bill in speaking to that motion.

[01:20:51] The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, Senate Bill 327 does two things: One, it directs our utilities to create an eight-year program to fund energy efficiency, residential solar, and residential storage for income and age qualified customers this is about helping lower bills for people that most need bills to be lowered this provision could end up being almost 300 million dollar investment into peak load reduction resilience reliability and cost affordability the second piece it does is it asks the SEC to host a technical conference on the concept of pay-as-you-save a version of on-bill financing where utilities cover the cost of energy upgrades and customers

[01:21:30] day one in lifetime savings while paying back the upgrades. If the SEC determines it would be feasible, the utilities would be required to propose programs by May of 2027. I move passage of the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 327 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those

opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21,

[01:22:05] noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. Senate bill 327 passes. Senate bill 336, a bill to direct the state air pollution control board to amend its regulations regarding the use of data center emergency generators. Senator from Western Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, madam president as the substitute version that got out of senate finance now has made this into a happy little section one bill so what does that do the it says that the state corporation commission shall evaluate the impact of requiring data centers to limit the use of tier two generators

[01:22:45] and prioritize the use of tier four gen tier four equivalent or better generators it gives four clauses about that and then ask them to report back to the chairs of ag senate finance house ag and house probes by october 15th of this year so study bill and with that i renew passage of the bill the question is shall senate bill 336 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators

[01:23:18] desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 38 no zero rule 361 ayes 38 no zero rule 361 senate bill 336 passes senate bill 371 a bill relating to electric utilities high energy demand customers state corporation commission to establish electric demand flexibility programs reports the senior senator from prince william thank you madam president move the bill pass and speak to the motion the senator has the floor thank you madam president senate bill 371

[01:23:59] directs the state corporation commission to set up regulations necessary for demand flex program it's a voluntary program and probably one of the most important things we can do in terms of high energy users to allow them to invest in private solutions private dollars to private solutions to reduce the peak energy load this program is voluntary it directs the sec to develop regulations following their december technical conference and ask that the bill pass i know it got some opposing votes in committee not sure why I think there's probably confusion with other bills that are passing through there but this bill has no objections that I'm aware of and as private solutions to real-world problems

[01:24:38] and ask the bill pass the senator from Eastern Fairfax a mad president speaking to the bill senator has the floor and president we spent I think about probably about four hours in committee hearings or Commission meetings over the last year You're looking at demand response as part of the Commission on Electrical Utility Regulation.

[01:24:56] I know there's been a lot of talk about data centers and doing something about them. This is one of the most meaningful things we could do about the energy demand that data centers are placing on our grid right now. What this will basically do is allow data centers to reduce their electricity consumption if it's needed in the event there's a surge in demand that creates a stress on the system.

[01:25:17] And demand response is absolutely critical in solving that problem. And this is, I think, sort of a good first step on demand response. We're going to need to do more work going forward to figure out if there's other ways we can incentivize these heavy electrical users to reduce their demand when needed.

[01:25:36] But in the short term, doing a voluntary program like this is excellent. And I'd hope everybody could support this so that we have more flexibility in dealing with demand in high demand events. Given the state of the grid right now, we'll see where things go with the weather.

[01:25:54] But everybody should go green on this because it'll give us the flexibility to deal with that situation should it arise. The question is, shall Senate Bill 371 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[01:26:10] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? clerk will close the roll. Ayes 26, noes 13. Ayes 26, noes 13. Senate Bill 371 passes. Senate Bill 377, a bill relating to electric substation construction agreements, electric cooperatives. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill passes. Senator has the floor.

[01:26:48] Thank you, Madam President. I explained this bill on the floor yesterday because there was a floor sub on it but the quick version is is it allows a a utility customer to construct a substation in co-op territory and then has the sort of standards by which they have to build it assume liability for it maintenance for it and then turn it over at no cost to co-op customers and again i fully explained this yesterday i'd hope we can pass the bill the question is shall senate bill 377 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes i those opposed no are the

[01:27:22] the senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. Senate Bill 377 passes. Senate Bill 407, a bill relating to electric utilities, transportation, electrification, electric vehicle, fast charging stations.

[01:27:50] The senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. I move that the bill passed. Speaking briefly to the bill. The senator has the floor. First we, it appears that we need to, do I need to do anything to process it or is everything in order? Okay. This is a bill that supports development of a reliable and equitable electric vehicle charging infrastructure market in Virginia. We passed this bill last year through the General Assembly. It was vetoed by the

[01:28:22] governor, and I move that we pass the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 407 now pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 1. Ayes 38, noes 1. Senate Bill 407 passes. Senate Bill 491.

[01:29:01] A bill relating to public schools, right to free public elementary and secondary education, discrimination based on immigration, status prohibited, requirements, civil case of action.

[01:29:18] Senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speaking to that. The Senator has the floor. Thank you. so this bill basically says that all students in the commonwealth will have access to a free public education regardless of their actual or perceived immigration status that is already in the virginia constitution and has also been upheld in pleiler versus doe in 1982 in january of last

[01:29:55] year the Trump administration revoked a sensitive locations policy put in place during Biden's time that protected certain areas including schools from immigration enforcement actions. While the administration now claims that it does not conduct enforcement operations in schools, the revoking of this policy certainly leaves the door open for that to become the case. This legislation codifies and clarifies the rights and protections of our students and our families. It would prohibit schools from collecting or publicly disseminating

[01:30:32] information on a student's actual or perceived immigration status. It includes protecting students who may appear to be foreign and face potential discrimination. It prohibits schools and their

staff from disclosing or threatening to disclose information about a student's status as well as prohibiting SROs from participating in immigration enforcement. The bill requires schools to create written policies for warrant review procedures to ban entry without proper judicial authority, documenting law enforcement

[01:31:10] interactions on school grounds, and providing parental notification before allowing immigration enforcement access to students. This bill does not prohibit immigration enforcement operations with the proper judicial warrants. It does not prohibit compliance with federal information sharing requirements on federal immigration authority obligations. It also does not prohibit information requests about a student status that are required by federal law. What this does is it says that our schools should be safe spaces

[01:31:48] for our students where they should be able to go every day without fear of discrimination because of how they look or their perceived citizenship status or their actual citizenship status and our educators are not there to enforce these types of issues. So with that I hope it passes. The question is, shall Senate Bill 491 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those

[01:32:26] opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, knows 18. Ayes 21, knows 18. Senate Bill 491 passes. Senate Bill 508, a bill to direct certain electric utilities to undertake comprehensive assessments and establish pilot programs related to surplus interconnection service report.

[01:33:00] The senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass and speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, this bill is about surplus interconnection service we've seen a lot of energy bills today and I think those bills have two things in common one is about getting more energy online and the other is maximizing the capacity of the grid we already have and that's what this bill is about if you follow RTO's you know that one of the biggest problems we have with getting energy online is that it takes about five to seven years to bring large-scale generation through the interconnection process with PJM PJM has

[01:33:37] recently created rules around allowing for surplus interconnection service and essentially what this is is we have dozens of generation sites across the state that only operate at a portion of their capacity where there's a delta where they can provide more so as an example the grass field solar facility in Chesapeake is rated at 20 megawatts if we coupled it with battery storage we could raise its capacity 70% we can get cheaper energy online faster to provide energy we need and at lower cost to ratepayers. This bill does two things: it directs the utilities to assess interconnection capacity at their

[01:34:15] existing and planned sites, and to identify at least two to five locations where this is feasible, and then it asks them to establish an RFP where they can establish a pilot program of up to a hundred megawatts for APCO and 500 megawatts for Dominion, respectively. I think this is a bill that got partisan committee. I think this is a bill we can all get behind. This is a bill about maximizing the grid we already have getting energy online as fast as we can at its cheap cost to a ratepayer it's gonna save ratepayers money it's gonna help solve our energy problems and I would hope we could all vote for it

[01:34:48] today so I move we passed the bill the question is shall Senate bill 508 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senator

senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 15, rule 36-1. Ayes 23,

[01:35:19] noes 15, rule 36-1. Senate Bill 508 passes. Senate Bill 628, a bill relating to Department of Housing and Community Development Eviction Reduction Program report. The senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill passed and speaking to that. The senator has the floor thank you madam president uh this bill would codify dhcd's virginia eviction reduction pilot program to to promote housing stability it to identify barriers that contribute

[01:35:58] to eviction filings and provide interventions to prevent or divert evictions the bill would make the program permanent to help reduce evictions in the commonwealth and promote housing stability and with that explanation madam president i move that senate bill 628 pass the question is shall Will Senate Bill 628 pass?

[01:36:18] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:36:35] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 17. Ayes 21, noes 17. Senate Bill 628 passes. Senate Bill 640, a bill relating to Department of Social Services, corrective action plans, Assumption of Temporary Control of Local Boards and Local Departments, Centralized Intake System for Reports or Complaints of Child Abuse or Neglect.

[01:37:07] The Senator from Washington. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass and speak in the bill. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, Senate Bill 640 addresses three longstanding structural gaps in Virginia's child welfare system, gaps that have kept the Commonwealth lagging behind much of the nation in key performance measures.

[01:37:26] this legislation represents a broad bipartisan effort it's gained support from the former yunkin and the current spanberger administrations as well as both senators warner and kane because protecting vulnerable children should never be a partisan issue i would be remiss if i did not acknowledge the strong advocacy and stakeholder work that my friend the senator from arlington has done in shaping this legislation so madam president i hope it would be the body that will the body that this bill pass the senator from arlington has the floor

[01:38:07] madam president i rise to speak in support of the bill the senator has the floor uh thank you madam president uh the senator from washington was an excellent collaborator on this bill and I thank him for his patience. Right now, I think the bill is much better than when we started, and I can say that the state Virginia Association of Social Service Directors is much more comfortable and believes that they have been heard and are ready to be good partners.

[01:38:37] I would just articulate three important aspects of this lengthy bill. First, the local departments will now have to respond to valid reports within 24 hours if there's a report that comes in regarding a possible abuse or neglect of a child under the age of three which is really important we we don't have a good standing in this area but more importantly it's going to allow the Commissioner of the Department of Social Services to work with the local departments in creating a corrective action plan if in fact they cannot go out quickly

[01:39:17] enough and do an adequate job in investigating these calls that are coming in for our very young children. So this corrective action plan, in effect, can be agreed to by both parties. But lastly, I do

want to say that records will be kept, a study will be done so we can and figure out how we can actually help the localities reach the local departments of social services, reach a higher standard of quality when it comes to really investigating valid cases of child abuse and neglect and doing the follow-up that's necessary to keep

[01:39:54] our children safe and to support our families. And that's really what this bill is about and I am excited to say we should pass it. Thank you, Madam President. Senator from Washington, for what purpose do you rise? Madam President, if no one else wants to speak, after that hearty Valentine Day endorsement of my bill, I move that the bill pass.

[01:40:17] The question is, shall Senate Bill 640 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:40:34] Do any senators desire to change their vote? the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39 no zero. Ayes 39 no zero the Senate Senate shows its love to the Senator from Washington. Senate bill 651 a bill relating to qualifying localities underground electric distribution and transmission improvements levy on utility customers by ordinance. Senior Senator from Loudoun. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move the bill passed in speaking to that motion the senator has the floor my president this

[01:41:13] is a bill that allows planning district there's in plenty district eight and planning district nine so portions of my district it allows it gives localities an additional toolbox in their initial tool in their toolbox to allow for them to tax our high high energy users to help pay for the cost of undergrounding as transmission lines have grown not only the number of them that are required but the size of them up in my district in Loudoun and Fauquier counties we have seen them traverse our schools traverse our churches and be put in places where they were never anticipated and not just the sort of

[01:41:51] polls that you might regularly expect to see but some of the largest transmission lines transmission lines that heretofore did not exist in the Commonwealth of Virginia madam president and so this just gives localities of tools to the tool a tool to ensure that the folks who are primarily responsible for those help to pay the cost to underground those so that we can protect our residences and communities thank you madam president the question is shall Senate bill 651 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do

[01:42:27] any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 22 Ayes 22, Noes 17, the Senate Bill 651 passes.

[01:42:44] Senate Bill 658, a bill to direct the Secretary of Administration to convene a work group on automatic voter registration. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:43:00] I move the bill pass. And speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The bill just directs the Secretary of Administration to study the automatic voter registration in the Commonwealth.

[01:43:15] The question is, shall Senate Bill 658 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:43:30] The clerk will close the roll. It's already closed.

[01:43:49] she can do it she can we strike the vote without objection the vote will be stricken so that a member may cast her vote the clerk will open the roll have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk

[01:44:26] will close the roll it's 21 knows 18 eyes 21 knows 18 Senate bill 658 passes Senate Bill 661, a bill relating to Virginia Small Business Economic Development Act established Virginia Alcoholic Beverage Control Authority regulation and taxation of skill game machines penalties.

[01:44:58] The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass. I'm speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, we have seen this bill before. It's a bill that has passed 32 to 8 off this floor. Speaking to the substitute that came from the Finance Committee, this bill essentially is a bipartisan bill and it continues to strengthen and really try to drive out the illegal market of skilled games, which there are over 90,000 of these games that are illegal, that are out there.

[01:45:32] This bill attempts to put a cap on that. It requires all machines to be certified by a national third party. It prohibits anyone from under 21, and with some of the recommendations coming from the General Laws Committee, it also put in strengths to make sure that ID is shown in order to play these games as well.

[01:45:54] It limits the number of terminals per location. It implements a 25% tax on gross proceeds. and also levies heavy penalties for those possessing or operating these machines as well. And so, again, what this bill does, it establishes a clear, enforceable, and responsible regulatory framework for skilled games in our Commonwealth, Virginia, by supporting our small businesses and making sure also that this framework is in place.

[01:46:26] With that, I move the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 661 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:46:44] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 24, noes 15. Ayes 24, noes 15. Senate Bill 661 passes.

[01:47:00] Senate Bill 665, A bill relating to Department of Housing and Community Development, local housing policy report to department. The junior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speaking to that motion.

[01:47:17] The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 665 updates the annual DHCD reporting requirements for localities to include actions that impact housing development, including changes to zoning, fees, and unit approval data.

[01:47:33] This will strengthen the Commonwealth's ability to collect and analyze meaningful local housing data and gives policymakers a clearer picture of housing production statewide. I hope it's the will of the body to adopt this bill. Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall Senate Bill 665 pass?

[01:47:53] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? - The clerk will close the roll.

[01:48:08] - Ayes 21, noes 18. - Ayes 21, noes 18, Senate Bill 665 passes. - Senate Bill 666, a bill relating to the Department of Housing and Community Development, Housing Development Database.

[01:48:25] - The junior senator from Loudoun. - Thank you, Madam President, I move the bill pass and speaking to that motion. - The senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 666 directs DHCD to establish a public, statewide clearinghouse to track key data on new and existing housing developments across all localities, including permitting timelines, to improve transparency and accountability in the housing production.

[01:48:55] This database must be updated every year so that policymakers, local officials, and the public have up-to-date, reliable information on where housing is built, what is being proposed, and how our housing supply is changing over time. I hope it's a will of the body to adopt this bill.

[01:49:10] Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall Senate Bill 666 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:49:27] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 28, noes 11. Ayes 28, noes 11. Senate Bill 666 passes.

[01:49:43] Senate Bill 685, a bill relating to standards of quality, school board policies, communication and language accessibility for limited English proficient parents' requirements report.

[01:50:02] Senator from Western Fairfax. I move the bill pass in speaking to that. The senator has the floor. Thank you. Currently, federal law requires schools to accommodate English limited language students, But the current federal administration has recently rescinded its existing guidance on how to do that.

[01:50:24] So it's kind of left a dark space for schools as to what they should be doing. So this bill just codifies and enshrines the previously existing federal guidance into Virginia law, providing our ELL students with the support that they have always had and continue to need to ensure that we can continue to close the achievement gaps that exist.

[01:50:54] Some of the provisions in this bill just says that translation of critical and vital documents needs to be provided, oral interpretation to parents situations that require immediate communication be provided our schools are doing this currently and this just ensures that the Commonwealth believes it is important and critical so I move the bill pass the question is shall Senate bill 685 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do

[01:51:33] any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. Senate Bill 685 passes. Senate Bill 725. Senate Bill 716. A bill relating to the Commissioner of Highways, certain agreements with the U.S. Department of Transportation, National Environmental Policy Act. The senator from Western Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The

senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:52:18] President SP716 authorizes the Commissioner of Highways to enter into agreements for a term of five years for the U.S. Department of Transportation as provided for in federal law regarding state assumptions of responsibility for categorical exclusions and the surface transportation project delivery program.

[01:52:33] The bill authorizes the Department of Transportation to assume certain responsibilities of the U.S. Secretary of Transportation pursuant to such an agreement. Under the bill, the Commonwealth waives its immunity from civil suit and federal court and under certain circumstances. but as we discussed when the bill came up in committee, this is actually routine and the state has prevailed in the two times that it has actually come up.

[01:52:56] The bill contains expiration date of five years after date of which the first agreement is entered into. I'd also like to thank the senior senator from Prince William as well as the senator from Hanover for both offering very kind comments about the process of this in committee. The whole point is because we think we can expedite delivery of projects and we can prevent cost escalation so we can save money.

[01:53:14] So with that, I renew passage of the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 716 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:53:31] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no, zero. Ayes 39, no, zero. Senate Bill 716 passes. Senate Bill 725, a bill relating to circuit court clerks' fees, technology trust fund fee.

[01:53:54] The senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the bill to pass. Speaking to that bill. Senator has the floor. Yes, ma'am. It does, as the clerk said. It just simply allows the clerk of each circuit court to assess a fee that's moved up from $5 to $8 to the fund that's simply known as the technology trust fund fee.

[01:54:16] And with that explanation, Madam President, I move the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 725 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:54:32] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. Senate Bill 725 passes. Senate Bill 756, a bill relating to casino gambling-eligible host localities.

[01:54:54] The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass and speak to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, Senate Bill 756 would expand casino gaming to Fairfax County in Northern Virginia.

[01:55:12] The way the bill originally was introduced, it limited it to a certain area of Fairfax County near a couple of malls and some metro stations. The bill, as it came out of Senate Finance, got amended to broaden it up to the entire county.

[01:55:29] And yesterday we made an amendment to clarify the intent of the Senate Finance Committee, which was to also require any project constructed to be at least 1.5 million square feet. Just so you have an idea what that would mean, that could include a concert venue, a conference center, a hotel,

entertainment district, IMAX center for sporting events, things like that, which is typically how projects of that size are designed and constructed.

[01:55:57] I just want to say, first of all, about this, you know, I first, this issue first got my attention back in 2015-16 when MGM announced they were opening a casino gaming complex right across the Potomac River from where I live.

[01:56:13] A lot of times I would go out walking my dog at night and go down to the GW Parkway and right across the river you could see it. It's pretty bright. And I read at the time they opened it that they planned for a huge amount of their business to come out of Virginia.

[01:56:32] And that really made me upset, made me so angry. In fact, I called up Senate Finance Chairman Senator Lucas, who I knew had been advocating for casino gaming in the state for a long time. And she and I wrote an op-ed in the Richmond Times Dispatch back in 2016 saying that we needed to do this in Virginia so that Maryland, North Carolina, West Virginia did not continue to pick our pockets.

[01:56:54] You know, there's also a facility over in West Virginia and Charlestown. We're seeing these things all over the place now. And since then, at the time, by the way, MGM anticipated $350 million a year of their revenue coming out of Virginia, which that's 10 years ago now.

[01:57:11] So now we've probably seen over four billion dollars of our money fly over the bridge into Maryland to pay for their schools And now National Harbor by the way that project is now the crown jewel of the Maryland gaming system MGM I think generated something like eight hundred fifty million dollars in casino revenue for them last year The MGM casino in Maryland is the number one best performing asset the MGM has outside of Las Vegas And I want you to think for a second about that.

[01:57:44] And when we did this study for JLARC, JLARC found that a project in Northern Virginia would generate more revenue than all the other casinos we've authorized in Virginia combined. And that's just not revenue for Northern Virginia, it's revenue for the entire state.

[01:58:03] And this has been studied, it was looked at, it was validated by JLARC. Now, did they come out with specific numbers? No, but they said it will generate more than all the other five combined. So, Madam Chair, you know, I went and did a little spreadsheet, and if you assume that a casino in Fairfax would generate $1.2 million in gaming revenue a year, that would generate about $232 million of revenue per year to the Commonwealth.

[01:58:33] So, if it does a little bit better than MGM, it would generate $232 million to the Commonwealth. That's $2.3 billion per decade for school construction, the way the bill is written right now. To the locality, it would generate $90 million a year of casino revenue to the county.

[01:58:49] That's $900 million a decade. And that's if it does $1.2 billion under its basic math. Just go look up the tax structure. It's in the code. If it does $800 million, which is less than MGM, it would generate about $1.4 billion per decade to the Commonwealth.

[01:59:06] And about $600 million over a decade to the county. And remember, in terms of the county, that doesn't even include real estate taxes. and if it's a three billion dollar project with a dollar 14 real estate tax think about the tax revenue that generates as well um madam president i also want to point out that virginia's school construction is behind they say we have a three billion dollar school construction

backlog maintenance backlog in this commonwealth this project alone could plug two-thirds of that hole on a statewide basis so think about that for a second this one vote i also just want to say that this project

[01:59:46] would generate a lot of jobs they say would generate 5 000 construction jobs and it would also generate 3 000 permanent jobs on the project what kind of jobs you know when i went to ncsl i don't know how many y'all went up to boston this year for the national consumer uh the national ncsl meeting national conference of state legislatures uh but uh there's a there's a casino up there a wind casino up there on the boston harbor and i walked over there and took a tour and on the tour they told me that if you want to be on the housekeeping staff there their salaries

[02:00:21] start at sixty thousand dollars a year the front desk clerks they all make six figures working at the front desk of a hotel i just want you to think about that you cannot get jobs like that in northern virginia without a college degree anywhere else and madam president this job this this bill would create jobs for folks in northern virginia that don't have college degrees they could afford to live in fairfax county which many people cannot afford to do right now so madam president i think think this bill would create a lot of opportunity for people in Northern Virginia it would also I think create a lot of benefits for our schools which

[02:01:00] need those investments across the Commonwealth I think it builds on the work of our Senate Finance Chairman over the last five six seven eight nine ten years now to create more opportunities to generate revenue for our localities in Northern Virginia and I would hope we get passed the bill the chair recognizes the senator from Lynchburg thank you madam president I rise to see the gentleman from Eastern Fairfax will rise for a question. Senator, will you yield? Senator from Lynchburg. Thank you, Madam President. Senator, I remember when this bill was coming through last

[02:01:39] year, there were a lot of projections about how much money would go into school capital funding, and you hit on that, you said 90 million. Then I heard the Senator talk about how it was going to do jobs, how much the jobs would pay in Fairfax. But for a low country boy in Lynchburg, Virginia, what is the benefit of this casino to the folks in my region? Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[02:02:11] Madam President, the way we've set up casino game in the Commonwealth from the beginning was that the revenue goes towards school construction. A portion of the revenue goes towards school construction. And the, again, if you put in, if you want to come over and play with my spreadsheet, I have it over here, but if you put in 1.2 billion dollars of gaming revenue, it would generate 232 million dollars per year of revenue that goes into the school construction fund. So right now, right now that construction fund gets somewhat less than that from the other

[02:02:47] five casinos around the state, and then school systems are allowed to access that school construction money if they meet certain criteria and actually Fairfax County has me able to access any of that revenue it's been mainly the rest of the state that's been using those school construction funds that are present senator you further question I'll yield well the senator yield he said do we have any percentage or the the is the rest of the state is it broken out to regions or anything at every region every school will have to apply for that general amount is that correct I think that's the way senator from Eastern

[02:03:22] in Fairfax thank you president sorry I jumped the gun yeah I think I'm actually not fully aware of exactly what the process is but there's I know that for example I don't think any of the Northern Virginia jurisdictions have been able to access the money because the way they fund schools I think it's been mainly funding schools and other parts of the Commonwealth and right now you know our existing

system is generating at least a hundred million dollars a year for that fund probably more than that probably about 150 million a year and all I know is it goes to school construction all right I think the

[02:03:58] gentleman from Eastern Fairfax the chair recognizes the senator from northern Fairfax madam chair the senator has the floor thank you madam chair I'm I mean considering what happened last year I can see where this is probably going but I would just ask the body to consider if if this is all accurate information

[02:04:23] And if all of the predictions are well-vetted and we have data-driven metrics, you would think that Fairfax County would be all over this.

[02:04:39] You would think that the supervisors would say, this is a great idea. It's going to save our economy. You would think that the people in Fairfax County would say, all righty, this is going to be great. But guess what? They don't. The Board of Supervisors of Fairfax County have taken an official vote and put it on their legislative agenda to say that they do not approve of this proposal, and we need to listen to that.

[02:05:08] Secondly, this has been polled several times. There have been a number of elections in Fairfax County over the past year, special elections from congressional races to House of Delegates races, and in every occasion, it has been over 50%. In fact, this summer, there was a poll that was done speaking to the voters of Fairfax County, and it was more than 75% in opposition. And in the area of Tyson's, which I appreciate that we've taken the direction that it has to be in Tyson's.

[02:05:48] It was 82% of the population. Now, we have, you know, commending resolutions where we all agree people love their firefighters and they love their dogs, but there are virtually no times when Republicans and Democrats and independents alike are united on a political issue.

[02:06:12] I go to the grocery store. I am stopped by my constituents. I have gone to the doctor. I have been stopped by my doctor when I was having a sick visit who said, please, do not bring a casino here. We don't need it.

[02:06:28] 600 people have repeatedly come to town halls to say, please, do not vote for this proposal. We don't want it. Real estate has been increasing. In fact, in the latest data that we have, Real estate in Fairfax County, especially in Tyson's, is better than in Washington DC or anywhere else.

[02:06:52] Our economy is strong. The planning process that Fairfax County has is one that is robust. They have spent more than 20 years with a broad group of stakeholders in the different regions who envision what they hope their communities will be.

[02:07:12] And there has not been a community that has asked for a casino. I would just say, this sounds great, right? The patron, he's very passionate and I respect that. I'm telling you, I live, eat and sleep in the communities where the people are most concerned.

[02:07:35] And this is not the way we should do it. If we have a gaming commission or some other body that can independently verify the numbers that the Senator from Eastern Fairfax County is talking about.

[02:07:52] I think that's the right step. But just us pushing this onto the Fairfax County Board of Supervisors, it will not pass a referendum. It is a very distressing political issue for all of us who live in that area.

[02:08:08] I would ask the people listen to what I'm having to say here and think about what you would do this was in your own community and have a little respect that perhaps you know while we're all getting

candy today this is not just all candy the senator from Alexandria thank you madam president rise to speak to the bill the senator has the floor briefly I would just like to remind the body that all the other

[02:08:45] casinos that we've authorized in Virginia came about when the host locality asked for casino to spur economic development sometimes in economically challenged communities. This would be a significant departure from past practice. The host locality, Fairfax County, is not asking for this authority. In fact, as the senator from Northern Fairfax said, they are telling us that they don't want that authority to put it on the ballot. Further, I appreciate that the bill has been widened that if this were to pass that

[02:09:21] it could be anywhere in Fairfax County, but I know the proponents wanted to go in Tyson's corner and there's been some information about how Tyson's was kind of going to hell in a handbasket and buildings were selling on the market at low prices that weren't filling up, but I wanted to just set the record straight and say as of the final quarter of 2025 in Tyson's, it has the lowest offense vacancy rate in Northern Virginia and indeed one of the lowest rates in metropolitan Washington region even less than downtown DC part of it driven by the signing of new office leases more than a million square feet last year

[02:10:01] office rents are increasing trophy office rents significantly so as office tenants and their employers seek the kind of transit oriented workplaces near housing and retail the Tysons has to offer and housing retail are thriving with 1.25 million square feet of residential development currently under construction in Tyson's including new apartments and condos for robust and growing population. Tyson's retail economy is especially strong with an extraordinary low 2.4 percent retail vacancy rate. Last year Tyson's welcomed

[02:10:34] 42.6 million retail visitors and 65 percent of the of a the 2.4 billion dollars a year that Tyson's has spent comes from out-of-market visitors. I got this information from the Tyson's Community Alliance you could check their website at datahub.tysonsvia.org if you want to double check those insights but if if Fairfax wanted this I would consider voting for it if there was an area near the senator's home that needs help on the bus rapid transit line or or somewhere that's not yet developed to put a conference center that could be an

[02:11:11] economic boon but Fairfax doesn't want it so with that I ask that we vote against the bill. The chair recognizes the senator from Arlington. Thank you madam president. I'm speaking in opposition to the bill. The senator has the floor. Thank you madam president. I at first would like to ask the senator from Eastern Fairfax if he would yield for a question or two. Will the senator yield? Sure. The senator from Arlington. Thank you madam president. I want to know

[02:11:48] if you have contemplated, or if it's specific in this bill, a different revenue share for the locality than we have normally given to the other five jurisdictions that are hosting a casino. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. What I would say to the senator is that I have repeatedly asked the County Board of Supervisors if they would like to have a different revenue share to propose one and they've refused to propose one and I also think that giving one county a different revenue share than other counties would be kind of a weird way to

[02:12:27] do things in Virginia but there are some other ways to probably possibly structure the revenue given the size of this project compared to the others but you know I'm happy to have that conversation as soon as the board of supervisors chooses to engage in it madam president I I think the senator from Eastern Fairfax made my point. The Board of Supervisors is not even...

[02:12:54] The Senator is speaking to the bill. I am speaking to the bill. Thank you. The Senator has the floor. Thank you. The Board of Supervisors has not even had a robust conversation on this. They have decided that the planning effort, the effort that the locality would have to put forth regarding public infrastructure, safety questions, transportation, and even national security issues far outweigh the desirability of engaging in this conversation. The Board of Supervisors in the last correspondence that was sent to lawmakers officially

[02:13:32] had the position of, no, we don't want this authority, and if we were given this authority, we would not use it. I think that really speaks volumes. I think the senator from Northern Fairfax made the point when other jurisdictions came to the state asking for authority for a casino, they were united. They'd already had a plan. They knew what they wanted.

[02:13:59] They were ready to move forward. That is not the case with this proposal. This is not fully cooked. It is not the right thing to do, and I strongly urge the body to vote no. The chair recognizes the senator from Mecklenburg.

[02:14:17] Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill. The senator has the floor. I never ever thought I'd get up and talk about a casino, but I want to talk about a casino and then maybe a little something else.

[02:14:35] So I never have voted in favor of a casino, but I'm going to vote in favor of this bill. Talking about the part where money goes to school construction, I just want to tell you that in my district, which is the largest land district in the state, and very rural, all rural, actually, Danville City received $3.5 million for a school construction project.

[02:15:10] Lunenburg County received $16.5 million for a school construction project. Mecklenburg County for an elementary school, $7.6 million. Pennsylvania County for an elementary school, $2.5 million for a school construction project.

[02:15:32] My district, which is seven counties in one city, received the most money from casino revenues than any other district in the state. this is one reason this is really probably the only reason I'm voting for this bill but as I was sitting here thinking about this and the reason and listening to the reasons senator from the redcoat love district Arlington

[02:16:07] Eastern Fairfax Eastern Fairfax was talking about the jobs and the revenue it really made me think about something else that I would love for the other other side of the well it's not just the other side of the aisle it's also my side of the aisle when you talk about data centers and I know this is off subject but I want to relate it because in my district which is rural and where we need revenue to pay for things that I can't seem to get anybody here to realize how badly we need where I have 50 fire departments and a handful of paid

[02:16:45] firemen and EMS and one day in my district we're gonna dial 9-1-1 and no one's gonna show up because people don't volunteer for these things anymore and our our firefighters and EMS volunteers are in their 60s right now that a data center is life-changing for us in Mecklenburg County alone we have 12 so I'm comparing this to the things that a casino can bring to Northern Virginia a data center can bring to a little rural community like Mecklenburg

[02:17:22] County these numbers are just from 2023 not what's happened since then Microsoft up till 2023 had been in Mecklenburg County 13 years brought 499 very high paying jobs very high paying jobs plus

966 other jobs that were not as high paying but still in my community very high paying um for every job they create they create another

[02:17:57] two additional jobs in industries in the in our community 2.7 million total community investment that's just little projects that they fund as a community they fund projects outside of the data center 350 000 people have impacted by their being in in mecklenburg county and we have data centers that aren't microsoft so this is just just microsoft um the people that work there make 2.4 times higher compensation than people that work in our community and other jobs the average

[02:18:36] compensation is between 154 000 and 65 000. this is unheard of it's 21 percent of regional active economic activity it contributed to 276 million in regional gp gdp they are partners in our community that we could we just in everything they're involved in sports children community everywhere

[02:19:07] you look there they are 107 70 million in labor income annually 5 million in local sales tax 250 million in regional economic activity 99 million in property taxes just from 2019 to 2023 1.3 billion total regional economic activity 12 500 jobs supported our real estate taxes which were

[02:19:39] already low or have been lowered twice in the last four years we are now 36 cent on 100. do you want to move to mecklenburg county i'm a real estate agent and we have the largest lake in virginia and north carolina anyway i'm just saying when you're thinking about data centers think about what it's done to my community and some of these rural communities that want one let's think about energy let's think about you want to send all the solar our way well solar

[02:20:15] brings in almost no economic jobs or revenue for us or tax base but a data for what purpose does the senator from northern Fairfax rise thank you madam president I rise to ask the senator from Mecklenburg a question okay I'm sorry I'm off topic yes well the senator well is that what you're asking what is this have to do with those casinos? Senator. Senator. Madam President, I have another question for her.

[02:20:47] Will you yield for a question? Thank you, Madam President. The Senator from Northern Fairfax has the floor. Would you, Madam President, I'd like to ask the Senator if she is aware what the gross domestic product of her community where the casino in Southside was when they allowed the casino to come the senator from mecklenburg yes madam president um i do not but i do know that the economy grew substantially in danville when we built the casino in fact the whole region there

[02:21:25] in the danville pittsylvania area um completely changed the landscape um and it has grown i mean everything there has the downtown has been revitalized the economy has grown and our crime rates have actually gone down but that was because of a very good partnership with Caesars I don't know that all partnerships are that good madam president senator from northern Fairfax the center and Mecklenburg say that it was in the hundreds of millions will she yield for another question senator from Mecklenburg will you yield yes I will yield senator from northern Fairfax thank

[02:22:04] you madam president my question would be if the senator from Mecklenburg would estimate that it was in the tens of millions and the hundreds of millions and the billions what would what would her estimate be for the revenue generation in in the South Side in Danville senator from Mecklenburg has the floor since I probably should have studied that more than I did the data centers which I'm very passionate about I would say it was probably in the tens of millions okay yes thank you madam president um is may have another quick may ask another question

[02:22:40] please will the senator yield for another question senator from mecklenburg yes i'll yield thank you madam senator from northern fairfax thank you madam president um is the senator from mecklenburg aware that um projections are uh on the gross domestic product in fairfax county um around 146 billion with a b to over 167 billion dollars with another b um driven heavily by its status as the major economic driver in northern virginia it is the

[02:23:20] fiscal powerhouse of the commonwealth and it has a gdp higher than 17 other states in 2025 And my question would be, does she think the same situation that was so wonderful for Mecklenburg and the surrounding areas would, is that, are we, we're not talking apples and oranges, would you agree?

[02:23:50] Senator from Mecklenburg. Well, the casino is in Danville. Sorry, Madam President, yes, I'll yield and I'm answering the question the best I can. So the casino is in Danville, which is an hour from Mecklenburg, but I'm probably speaking out of terms since I am not as educated on the casino and its earnings in the community to say whether it is apples to apples.

[02:24:20] But I might have a question for the senator from, I'm sorry, I don't have my guidebook out. Northern Fairfax. I don't speak very often. That's okay. the senator from Fairfax Northern Fairfax does the senator from Mecklenburg have a question for the senator does the senator from Northern Fairfax yield for the question and I do senator from Mecklenburg has the floor the way you speak of the casino and all that it the the largeness of it it sounds like it's a pretty good idea so I thought you were against it madam

[02:24:57] president to respond to the senator from Northern Fairfax madam president And I served on the subcommittee that originally enabled localities who had economically distressed regions to apply for the ability to have a casino referendum in their communities.

[02:25:17] And in that process, they showed, and it's in our code, says that these are economically distressed communities who are coming forth to the General Assembly to ask for the ability to hold a referendum that's a difference from where the fairfax casino is and the reason madam president and i would tell the senator from mecklenburg is that fairfax county and especially northern fairfax county is the economic generator and driver uh producing about 25 percent

[02:25:53] of virginia's entire gdp already so i don't think that the uh the this the um stipulations that we placed in the rest of the commonwealth on allowing a casino are anywhere in the same range to what fairfax county has and i think that the federal reserve of richmond actually said that they did not believe that the casino in Northern Virginia would make a significant contribution to their

[02:26:27] economy. And I question and I doubt the numbers that the good senator from Eastern Fairfax County is providing. I've not seen any backup data to support the numbers that he's been stating. So I I will again make it clear to the Senator from Mecklenburg that I am in strong opposition as all of my members of my community, all of the elected officials who are in the community and the majority of Fairfax County's Board of Supervisors

[02:27:03] has made a specific statement to the General Assembly saying that they do not want this casino authorization, They have not asked for it. They do not believe that it will do what the patron says it will do.

[02:27:18] And just wanted to make sure that it's very clear. I supported all of the times when the localities came and asked for it. Each time, the local government officials came to Richmond to request the ability to have a casino.

[02:27:37] That is not the case here. It is different. And I would ask my colleague and the rest of you, of our colleagues here in the community, Madam President, to take that into strong consideration when they cast their ballot. And I would ask them to vote no.

[02:27:56] - The Senator from Mecklenburg was speaking to the bill. Does the Senator wish to continue? - Yes, Madam Prejudice. - The Senator has the floor. - So the Caesars Virginia Casino in Danville its first year brought in 1200 jobs and 39 million dollars and that was to a very rural distressed area and um so i just want to reiterate that i am going to support the bill because of the school construction money that we could not do without in a rural area where we're very much in need of this money for our school systems um we we are very thankful for that for that school

[02:28:34] construction fund and we appreciate our data centers and need more energy resources from nuclear natural gas thank you the chair recognizes the senator from Lynchburg thank you madam president rise to speak to the bill the senator has the floor thank you madam president I have been torn on this bill since we've been talking about it for several years now and I've well just today today several years today well that was mainly data centers that was mainly data centers so back to the casino bill and and I voted against like

[02:29:12] my friend from Mecklenburg voted against all the other casino referendums but I think I'm gonna have to end in most of the gambling bills but and I want to explain my position but today for two reasons I think I am gonna have to vote yes for this bill first for the money that it may send to our schools to our schools in my region which which need or bad in bad shape a senator from Rocky Mount has been focused on for so long our capital projects for schools are in desperate shape and I appreciate that and we got five of them I'm not sure one

[02:29:52] in Fairfax is gonna make that much difference for the soul of the Commonwealth and two probably the most important reason not and not seem uncharitable madam president but the sheer disarray that this is causing amongst my Democratic friends in Northern Virginia I cannot let this opportunity go and the thought that this that this may be on the ballot this November when seven people are gonna be running for Congress with a portion of Fairfax after y'all's gerrymander bill to see them have to take a position on

[02:30:30] this and if it's not this year then it's next year when the entire body with most of y'all being from Northern Virginia and Fairfax are gonna have to take a picture a position on this in 2027 for those reasons I cannot pass up this opportunity to give you all that joy come November whenever you get to it going to have to support this bill seeing no other senators that wish to speak does the senator from eastern fairfax wish to make final comments speaking of the bill nobody else has any comments briefly the senator has the floor thank you madam president ladies and gentlemen first of all i want to point

[02:31:09] out the fairfax county is a big place it's larger than eight states 1.1 million people and the majority of the senators who support who represent the county support the legislation board of supervisors yeah they took a vote it was a 5-4 vote when they had a vacancy on the board uh that vacancy since been filled but I would also just say with regard the revenue split they one of their biggest complaints about the bill is the revenue split and I've said to them okay you got a problem with revenue split give me a proposal they won't give a proposal so I would I would game game to say that if they want to know if they want to make a proposal we're happy to consider it

[02:31:47] with regard to the polling you know you can make a poll say almost anything you want and if all you say is you know you want a casino sure they're gonna answer it one way but if you say to people in Fairfax County would you prefer a casino or a 10% tax increase what do you think they're gonna say okay and this project would generate the equivalent of about 10 cents on the dollar in real estate taxes in Fairfax County but you know what when you don't ask the questions a certain way people answer them a certain way so I just want everybody to remember that when they hear about all this polling now I just want everybody to remember there's been all these mailers that have been appearing in Fairfax County mailboxes now for the last two years from this mysterious organization

[02:32:27] based out of a peel box in Richmond with some name. Well, who do you think's been paying for that? You know, there's this thing across the river that's been sucking $300 million a year out of our state that stands to lose $3 billion a decade if we actually get this done.

[02:32:43] And how much money do you think they're willing to spend to get Fairfax County voters to say things on polls that are prejudiced them or whatever? Folks, MGM has their fingers in this. And by the way, if you get a bunch of emails again this year like you did last year, I would encourage you to write back to your constituent and ask them if they actually wrote the emails because there were people that got emails last year, they wrote back to their constituents who said, "I didn't send that email."

[02:33:04] So please, if you get those emails, please respond and ask them where they actually sent them. And the last thing I'll just say is I live across the river. I live closer to the MGM Casino than most of the people in Fairfax that are complaining about this live. You know what? Nothing has changed in the quality of life in the area that I live.

[02:33:21] We've seen zero effect from it. There's a lot of folks that are stirred up about it, but I would just ask them to be rational about it. At the end of the day, if this passes, voters will decide this, not us. I would hope we could pass this. The question is, shall Senate Bill 756 pass?

[02:33:39] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Of all the senators voted, do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:33:56] Ayes 23, noes 14. Ayes 23, noes 14. Senate Bill 756 passes. Senate Bill 757, a bill to direct the Board of Education to assess the feasibility and most appropriate manner to establish a Virginia African-American, Asian-American, Pacific Islander, Latino, and Indigenous Education Advisory Board. The junior senator from Loudoun.

[02:34:32] Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The senator has the Madam President, Senate Bill 757 requires the Board of Education to study how best to create a Virginia Advisory Board focused on African Americans, Asian Americans, Pacific Islander, Latino and Indigenous education.

[02:34:51] In doing so, the Board will examine the most effective structure, membership, responsibilities for such an advisory board and consider how it can support a more accurate, inclusive and comprehensive instruction about these communities in our schools.

[02:35:06] are required to be submitted by November 1st, 2026. I hope it is the will of the body to adopt this bill. Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall Senate Bill 757 pass? All in favor of that

motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[02:35:28] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:35:45] Ayes 35, noes 3. Ayes 35, Nose 3, Senate Bill 757 passes. Senate Bill 777, a bill relating to regional electric transmission entities, voting members, annual report.

[02:36:03] Junior Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speak into that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. All households and businesses in the Commonwealth are impacted by PJM policy, whether it relates to reliable operation of the grid, electric transmission planning and development, or wholesale power costs.

[02:36:25] The goal of this bill is to ensure transparencies into the development of the PJM policy by requiring voting members to submit an annual report to the Virginia State Corporation Commission with their voting record for the previous year. Delaware, Maryland, New Jersey, members of the PJM have already enacted similar legislation.

[02:36:44] And finally, this bill would just ensure that the State Corporation Commission has the right to request information regarding recorded votes cast by utilities, licensed suppliers, and/or end-use customers in any PJM venue where votes are taken.

[02:36:59] Madam President, I move the bill pass. Does the Senator from Western Fairfax wish to speak? The question is, shall Senate Bill 777 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[02:37:17] Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, noes 16.

[02:37:33] Ayes 22, noes 16. Senate Bill 777 passes. Senate Bill 827, a bill relating to pilot program for underground transmission lines qualifying projects levy report.

[02:37:54] The junior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass. I'm speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Madam President, Senate Bill 827 creates a pilot program that allows an electric utility and localities to work together to put transmission lines underground.

[02:38:10] The locality must cover at least 50% of the incremental cost through levies, bonds, or appropriations with any residential levy capped at 99 cents per month. The state corporation commission will review each project to ensure that it is in the public interest and it can require the locality to assume additional cost to protect other rate payers and can reject projects that are not feasible or against the public interest.

[02:38:36] It is a permissible option for both the locality and the utility. I hope it's the will of the body to adapt this bill. Thank you, Madam President. - The question is, shall Senate Bill 827 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no.

[02:38:52] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. - Ayes 26, noes 12.

[02:39:08] - Ayes 26, noes 12. Senate Bill 827 passes. Returning to page 17, Senate Bill 305. Senator from Western Fairfax.

[02:39:26] Madam President, I move to reconsider the vote by which this bill was engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall the vote by which Senate Bill 305 was moved to its third reading be reconsidered?

[02:39:46] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 34, noes 0.

[02:40:05] Ayes 34, noes 0. Senator from Western Fairfax. I move to withdraw the floor amendment number 1. Without objection, floor amendment number 1 is withdrawn. Senator from Western Fairfax. I waive the reading of floor amendments 2 through 4.

[02:40:21] The question is, shall the reading of the floor amendments now be waived? All in favor of that motion will say aye, those opposed no. The ayes have it. The reading of the floor amendment is waived.

[02:40:38] Senator from Western Fairfax. Madam President, I move the floor amendments two through four be agreed to in speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. So there's one technical amendment and these floor amendments really came from the teamwork that has started from the committee all the way through to these floor amendments.

[02:41:01] So I thank everyone who has helped make sure that we're getting to a good place. The first floor amendment adds an annual reporting requirement from the Department of Social Services to the Senate and House on the waiver program, on what types of waivers they've allowed to go through, how many of the locations, et cetera.

[02:41:24] And the second amendment also just tightened up the language that we can ensure that anybody who has ever been on a registry, such as a sex offender registry, even if they successfully have been moved off, that those people will not be eligible for this waiver process to foster parenting.

[02:41:43] And just to remind, um, and now I move the, uh, wait, do we need to take a vote on the floor amendments? Okay. That was it. just to clarify you are moving floor amendments one i'm sorry two three and four two three and four two three and four correct and that is your motion that's my motion the question is shall floor amendments pikarski floor amendments two three and four now be agreed to all in favor of that motion

[02:42:15] we'll say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it floor amendments two three and four are agreed to. Senator from Western Fairfax. Madam President, now I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall the floor, shall the, shall Senate Bill 305 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senator from Western Fairfax. I now

[02:42:48] move SB 305 and that it would be agreed to. That didn't make sense. I now move the bill in speaking to that motion. No, there's more? Senator, you will need to dispense with the reading. Oh, I move that we dispense with the reading, the third reading. The question is, shall the third reading of Senate Bill 305 now be

[02:43:21] dispensed with. All in favor of that motion will say aye. It is a recorded vote. My apologies. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, no zero. Ayes 37, no zero. The reading, the third reading is dispensed with.

[02:43:54] Senator Picard, Senator from Fairfax. And now that we have run the Senate Marathon, I move that this bill pass and speaking to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Alright, thank you Madam President. As previously described, this bill creates a waiver process for relatives and fictive kin who have been previously convicted of certain nonviolent crimes to be considered for foster parenting. Currently these folks are automatically denied with no consideration to rehabilitation or current life circumstances and this

[02:44:30] waiver process will be twofold it will be at the local level with the final decision being made at the state agents agency level and this will create some safeguards to ensure that the terrible and heartbreaking story that we heard earlier this week from the senator from Rockingham will be avoided the guidelines for this waiver process will be developed by the Department of Social Services and I hope it will be the will to agree to this bill of the

[02:45:00] body the question is shall Senate bill 305 be agreed to all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote The clerk will close the roll.

[02:45:25] Ayes 37, no 0. Ayes 37, no 0. Senate Bill 305 passes. On page 18, Senate Bill 643.

[02:45:44] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I ask that bill go by for the day. Without objection. Without objection, Senate Bill 643 goes by for the day. Page 19, Senate Bill 84.

[02:46:00] Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the bell pass and speaking to the motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. SB 84 as amended and with proper talking points. Strengthens Virginia's speed safety camera framework with clear guardrails, stronger oversight and enhanced transparency.

[02:46:22] The bill authorizes speed safety cameras in school crossing zones, highway work zones and designated high risk speed corridors, where a traffic fatality has occurred since January 1, 2014. It requires at least two conspicuous signs within 1,000 feet, including a speed display sign ensuring motorists receive clear notice.

[02:46:46] The bill maintains violations as civil penalties capped at $100 with no points and no insurance impact when issued by mail. It reinforces due process protections and clarifies rebuttable presumptions for vehicle owners.

[02:47:04] It strengthens accountability by requiring daily accuracy testing, documented calibration, annual reporting to the state police and the General Assembly, vendor transparency, and strict data retention limits.

[02:47:19] New cameras must issue warnings for the first 30 days of operation. Revenue is limited to program costs and traffic safety improvements with access directed to the Virginia Highway Safety Improvement Program. This bill's substitute, as read, keeps the focus where it belongs, prevention, transparency, and protecting lives of the most vulnerable in our traffic environments.

[02:47:47] Madam President, I renew my motion that the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 84 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[02:48:02] Do any senators desire to change their vote? clerk will close the roll. Ayes 27, noes 11. Ayes 27, noes 11. Senate bill 84 passes. Page 18, uncontested calendar. Senate bills on second reading. The chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move with all the Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 38 through 47, Senate bills 24 through 812. Be advanced there

[02:48:40] in Grossman in a block, in third reading in a block, after the adoption of any amendments thereto. Any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is shall all the senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 38 through 47 senate bill 24 through senate bill 812 now be engrossed in advance to their third reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments thereto that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the

[02:49:17] motion is agreed to the clerk will read the number of the bills senate bill 24 reported from the committee for courts of justice with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute the senator from eastern prince william thank you madam president madam president with the recommendation that the courts of justice substitute be rejected move that the amendment be agreed to. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. No. The

[02:49:53] noes have it. The substitute is rejected. Senator from Prince William. Madam President, I move that the Finance and Appropriations substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and appropriations be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 98 reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with the substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senator

[02:50:26] from Franklin County. Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. I now move that the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on general laws and technology be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:50:46] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 142 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate Bill 158 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with the substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The senior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the committee's substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the

[02:51:22] committee for courts of justice be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 190 reported from the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute. Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President.

[02:51:40] Madam President, I move that the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 274, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with the substitute. Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of

[02:52:14] that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 326, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate Bill 4, sorry, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with an amendment.

[02:52:35] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the committee amendment. The question is, shall the amendment from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendment is agreed to. Senate Bill 444, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a second.

[02:53:01] substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The Senior Senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[02:53:18] The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 453 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with the substitute. Senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. I move the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 464, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources. Senate Bill 523, reported from

[02:53:57] the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with an amendment. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the committee amendment be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendment from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendment is agreed to. Senate Bill 620, reported from the Committee on Rehabilitation and Social Services with a substitute, and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[02:54:29] senator from alexandria could that go by for the day in order to adopt a floor substitute on monday without objection senate bill 620 goes by for the day senate bill 626 reported from the committee on education and health with amendments and from the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute senator from charlottesville um yes ma'am on senate bill 625 with the recommendation that they be rejected I move that I move the amendments from the committee on education health

[02:55:06] with the recommendation that they be rejected the question is shall the amendments from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no no the noes have it the amendments are rejected senator from Charlottesville madam president I move that the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye any opposed no the ayes have it the

[02:55:39] substitute is agreed to senate bill 645 reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources with the substitute senator from eastern henrico madame president i still have not moved yet um senator from somewhere in fairfax eastern fairfax it stills keep me Madam President, I move the committee substitute.

[02:56:03] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 707, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources with the substitute, and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:56:26] The senator from York. Madam President, I move that the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to.

[02:56:43] Senate Bill 743, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The real senator from Eastern Henrico. Absolutely, Madam President. I move the committee's substitute be agreed to.

[02:57:00] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 778, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with the substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:57:20] The senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I move the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 812, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with Amendments.

[02:57:43] The senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Sorry, I've got a distraction. I move the committee's substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to?

[02:58:02] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President, I move the committee amendments be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee on Finance and Appropriation be agreed to?

[02:58:20] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Madam President, I move the... No? Okay. Thank you. the question now is shall the senate bills be engrossed and advanced to their third

[02:58:38] reading that is all bills except for page 44 sb 620. all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bills are engrossed and advanced to their third

[02:59:09] reading senator from eastern fairfax madam president move with all the senate bills now on third reading on the uncontested counter pages 38 through 47 senate bills 24 to 812 the rules be suspended in the third constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with the question is shall the rules be

suspended and the third reading of the titles of the bills be dispensed with all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close

[02:59:47] the roll. Ayes 38, no 0. Ayes 38, no 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. The bills are now before the Senate on final passage. Senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that all the Senate bills now on third reading uncontested calendar of pages 38 through 47.

[03:00:11] Senate bills 24 to 812 be placed on their final passage in a block. Any Senator desiring to move a bill from the block, please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, Shall the Senate bills on the uncontested calendar, third reading, pages 38 through 47, Senate Bill 24 through Senate Bill 812, be placed on their final passage in the block with the understanding that any senators desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[03:00:38] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the bills. senate bill 24 senate bill 98 senate bill 142 senate bill 158 senate bill 190 senate bill 274

[03:01:06] senate bill 326 senate bill 444 senate bill 453 senate bill 464 senate bill 523 senate bill 625 Senate Bill 707, 645, excuse me.

[03:01:32] Senate Bill 625, Senate Bill 645, and Senate Bill 707. Senate Bill 743, Senate Bill 778, Senate Bill 812.

[03:01:51] The question is, shall the bills in the block pass? All in favor of the passage of the bills will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[03:02:06] Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0, the bills in the block pass.

[03:02:21] Regular calendar, Senate bills on second reading. Senate Bill 496, a bill relating to secure storage of handguns, unintended locked vehicle penalty. Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from, and then it was recommitted and reported from the committee for courts of justice with amendments and there are five floor amendments the senior senator from fairfax thank you thank you madam president i believe i need to

[03:02:58] make three amendments here to get this bill ready for a motion to engross in advance the first is that the original meeting other the original uh substitute from the committee of courts of justice i move that that that substitute be adopted the question is shall the substitute from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senior senator from fairfax thank you madam president and this second very popular uh motion is that i withdraw the floor amendments senator do we need

[03:03:37] to adopt the amendments from the committee for courts of justice first i believe that those cut that comes next without objection the floor amendments are withdrawn thank you madam president and the third is that we adopt the final uh uh ruling of the uh uh the for the the amendments from the committee of the courts of justice the question is shall the amendments from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the floor of the amendments from the committee for courts of

[03:04:16] justice are agreed to senator from fairfax thank you madam president i now move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading the question is shall senate bill 496 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 15 a bill relating to driver improvement clinics motorcycle driver improvement clinics motorcycle driver improvement clinic fund

[03:04:54] created reported from the committee on finance and appropriations with a substitute senator from roanoke thank you madame president given this friday i think i'm going to ask that this go by for the day without objection senate bill 15 goes by for the day senate bill 783 a bill relating to law enforcement agencies or like localities agreements with federal authority i'm sorry

[03:05:31] there are too many bills on the calendar senate bill 609 a bill relating to revenues taxes gaming and lottery and i was looking forward to the motorcycles the senator from portsmouth thank you madam president i move that the committee substitute from senate finance and appropriation be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from portsmouth yes madam president i move that the bill be engrossed and

[03:06:09] advanced to his third constitutional reading the question is shall senate bill 609 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 783, a bill relating to law enforcement agencies or localities' agreement with federal authority for certain immigration enforcement limitations collection of data reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[03:06:49] And there are five floor amendments. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, could that bill go by for the day? With absolutely no objections, Senate Bill 783 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 1 relating to minimum wage reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[03:07:17] Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 1 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[03:07:34] The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 25, a bill to direct the director of the Department of Energy to identify and develop training resources to advance workforce development in the offshore wind industry.

[03:07:49] Reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with the substitute. The senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Finance and Appropriations Amendment be agreed to. Substitute. Substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to?

[03:08:08] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 25 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading?

[03:08:25] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 34, a bill relating to incapacitated persons' finding of lack of capability to understand active voting, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with the substitute.

[03:08:47] The senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be adopted. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[03:09:03] Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Arlington. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 34 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading?

[03:09:18] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 43, a bill to direct the Department of Energy to evaluate and assess the benefits and impacts of better practices and implementation recommendations for demand response programs report.

[03:09:44] Senator from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senator from Western Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move for the bill to be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 43 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[03:10:02] Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 62, a bill relating to modification of sentence for marijuana-related offenses, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[03:10:19] The Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that committee amendments from the Committee on Courts of Justice be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no.

[03:10:34] The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 62 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[03:10:51] The ayes have it, the bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 121, a bill relating to minimum wage, farm laborers, or farm employees, temporary foreign workers, reported from the Committee for Commerce and Labor with an amendment and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[03:11:14] The Senator from Eastern Prince William. Madam President, may this bill go by for the day. Without objection, Senate Bill 121 goes by for the day. bill 141 a bill relating to elections political campaign advertisements synthetic media penalty reported from the committee on privileges and elections with the substitute senator from central Fairfax thank you madam president I move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on privileges and elections be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye any opposed no the ayes have it

[03:11:52] substitute is agreed to senator from fairfax thank you madam president i move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading the question is shall senate bill 141 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it this bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 198 a bill relating to admissibility of statements by individuals with developmental or intellectual disabilities in certain cases reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with an amendment. The

[03:12:31] Senator from Arlington. Thank You Madam President. Madam President I move that the substitute from the Committee on Courts of Justice be agreed to. The question is shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the substitute is agreed to senator from arlington thank you madam president i move that the amendment from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no

[03:13:07] the ayes have it the amendment is agreed to senator from arlington madam president i move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 198 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[03:13:23] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 223, a bill to establish the Distributed Energy Resources Task Force Reports, Sunset, reported from the Committee on Rules with Amendments, and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[03:13:47] Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, with the recommendation that we reject the Rules Amendments, I move the Rules Amendments. With the recommendation that they be rejected, the question is, shall the amendments from the Committee on Rules be agreed to?

[03:14:07] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. No. The noes have it. The amendments are rejected. Senator from Henrico. Madam President, I move that the Senate Finance Committee substitute be agreed to.

[03:14:23] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading.

[03:14:39] The question is, shall Senate Bill 223 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 257, relating to health insurance coverage for prescription and non-prescription opioid antagonists.

[03:15:04] Reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. the senator from Arlington thank you madam president madam president I move that the substitute from Commerce and Labor be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Arlington thank you

madam president I now move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading the question is shall Senate bill 257 now be engrossed in advance to his third

[03:15:40] reading all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the sub the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 278 a bill relating to drug manufacturers permitting and registration certain conditions related to 340b covered drugs reported from the committee on education and health with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute the junior senator from loudon thank you madam president with the recommendation

[03:16:15] that the substitute from the committee on education and health be rejected i move the substitute be agreed to with the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no no the noes have it the substitute is rejected senator from loudon Madam President, I now move that the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to.

[03:16:45] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Loudoun. Madam President, I now move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading.

[03:17:04] The question is, shall Senate Bill 278 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 333 a bill relating to electric generation from remediated mine got gas renewable portfolio standard reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources with a substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute the senator from taswell thank you madam president with Rick

[03:17:41] recommendation that the substitute be rejected I move that the substitute be agreed to with the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the substitute from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the nose have it the substitute is rejected senator from taswell thank you Madam President, I move that the substitute from the finance and appropriation be agreed to.

[03:18:11] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Tazewell. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading.

[03:18:29] The question is, shall Senate Bill 333 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[03:18:45] Senate Bill 361, a bill relating to health insurance coverage for contraceptive drugs and devices, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[03:19:01] I'm sorry, Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Commerce and Labor Substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee

on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[03:19:17] The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Prince William. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 361 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[03:19:34] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 369: Relating to specialty civil court dockets, business and complex litigation dockets established, criteria for eligible actions reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[03:20:00] Senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Courts of Justice substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Prince William. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to his third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 369 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any Any opposed, no.

[03:20:33] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 376, a bill relating to motor vehicle collisions, preservation, and collection of certain mobile telephone data collision reports reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute, and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations, and there is a floor amendment.

[03:20:59] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the committee amendments, or committee substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[03:21:14] The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Fairfax. Move to waive reading of the floor amendment. The question is, shall the reading of the floor amendment be waived? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[03:21:29] The reading is waived. Senator from Fairfax. Move the floor amendment and speak to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, the floor amendment here was a request from the Virginia Department of Motor Vehicles so they would not have to change their collision report form, which they're not planning on doing until 2029. They do have a system called TREADS, which is a data collection system that they keep accident data in where people can collect the same information. And so they asked that I change this to say that the police report this information to TREADS, and that would avoid any kind of fiscal impact on the bill. And so that's

[03:22:06] what the amendment's about. The question is, shall the amendment, shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The floor amendment is agreed to. Senator from Fairfax. Move the bill to be engrossed and advanced to his third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 376 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading?

[03:22:30] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 382 a bill relating to smart solar permitting platform established reported from the committee on commerce and labor with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute senator from eastern fairfax with the recommendation to be rejected i

move the substitute from the committee on commerce and labor with the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the substitute from the committee on

[03:23:10] commerce and labor be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The no's have it. The substitute is rejected. Senator from Fairfax. Move the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Fairfax. Move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Senate Bill 382 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading.

[03:23:45] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 448, a bill relating to Electric Utilities, Energy Storage Resources, Department of Energy to Develop Model Ordinances, Work Groups Reports, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[03:24:14] The senior senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. With a recommendation that it be rejected, I move the substitute from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to?

[03:24:33] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The no's have it. The substitute is rejected. Senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to?

[03:24:52] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 448 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading?

[03:25:11] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 518, a bill relating to prevailing wage rate for public works, contracts, localities.

[03:25:27] Reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. Junior Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the committee substitute be rejected from the Committee of Commerce and Labor.

[03:25:46] With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The noes have it. The substitute is rejected.

[03:26:02] Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee substitute from the Committee of Finance and Appropriations be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye.

[03:26:18] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to his third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 518 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[03:26:34] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 619, a bill relating to electric utilities certificate of operation for high-load facilities reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with amendments and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[03:26:56] The junior senator from Loudoun. Madam President, I move that the committee amendments be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no.

[03:27:12] The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Senator from Loudon. Madam President, I now move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 619 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[03:27:29] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 644, a bill relating to labor and employment, payment of wages, minimum wage, overtime wages, misclassification of workers' civil actions reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. And President asked that bill go by for the day. Without objection, Senate Bill 644 goes by for

[03:28:04] the day. Senate Bill 659, a bill relating to solar interconnection grant program established reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. Senator from Chesapeake. Thank You Madam President. Madam President I move that the committee substitute from Finance and Appropriations be agreed to.

[03:28:31] The question is shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Chesapeake. Thank You Madam President. Madam President I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 659 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 673, a bill relating to cyberstalking penalty reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from

[03:29:10] the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The Senator from Mecklenburg. Madam President, and asks if that bill can go by for the day. - Without objection, Senate Bill 673 goes by for the day. - Senate Bill 688, a bill relating to campaign finance, campaign contribution limits, contingency, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections with an amendment.

[03:29:36] - Senator from Eastern Fairfax. - I would also ask that bill go by for the day. - Without objection, Senate Bill 688 goes by for the day. - Senate Bill 690, a bill relating to Department of Criminal Justice Services, Powers and Duties, Local and Regional Jails, Repeal of Model Addiction Recovery Program.

[03:29:57] Reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. - The junior senator from Loudoun. - Thank you, Madam President. I now move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third

constitutional reading. - The question is, shall Senate Bill 690 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[03:30:15] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 731 a bill relating to private companies providing public transportation services employee protections reported from the committee on local government with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations senator from central fairfax thank you madam president i move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on local government be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from

[03:30:54] fairfax thank you madam president i move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading the question is shall senate bill 731 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 758 a bill relating to solar energy facility work prevailing wage rate apprenticeship requirements civil penalties state and local tax exemption report reported from the committee on commerce and labor with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations

[03:31:31] the junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president i move the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on commerce and labor be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to. Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 758 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 759, a bill relating to unemployment

[03:32:08] benefits, increased weekly benefit amounts, emergency reported from the Committee on Finance and appropriation excuse me reported for the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute the senator from Alexandria I move the committee substitute the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Alexandria I now move the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third

[03:32:42] reading the question is shall senate bill 759 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 770 a bill relating to board of wildlife resources early special deer muzzle loading season hunting with dogs reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources with the substitute the senator from orange thank you madam president i would now move the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee

[03:33:20] on agriculture conservation and natural resources be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from orange thank you madam president i now move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional The question is, shall Senate Bill 770 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading?

[03:33:41] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 794, a bill relating to Virginia Health Care Protection Act established

prohibition or extradition for certain crimes penalties, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[03:34:09] The senior senator from Loudon. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the substitute from the Committee of Courts of Justice be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[03:34:27] The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Loudon. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 794 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 807 a bill to hunting with within certain areas of monroe bay prohibited westmoreland county reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources the senator from king george thank you madam president i move the bill be engrossed and

[03:35:07] advance to its third reading the question is shall senate bill 807 be engrossed and advanced to its third reading all in favor of that motion we'll say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced uncontested calendar uncontested calendar senate bill sorry uncontested calendar senate bills on first reading the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax

[03:35:46] matter president move all the senate bills on first reading on the uncontested regular calendars pages 68 through 79 senate bills 132 to 796 that the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading the titles be dispensed with the question is shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of the senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars pages 68 through 79 senate bill 132 through senate bill 796 be dispensed with all in In favor of that motion, we'll record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[03:36:21] Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 36, no 0.

[03:36:37] Ayes 36, no 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now now on their second reading be passed by for the day.

[03:37:00] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills will go by for the day.

[03:37:15] Supplemental calendar number one, uncontested calendar, Senate bills on first reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, move with all the Senate bills on first reading on the uncontested and regular calendars, pages one through 22 on the supplemental calendar number one.

[03:37:35] Bill 73 through 819 that the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with. The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, pages 1 through 22, Senate Bill 73 through Senate Bill 819 on supplemental calendar number 1, be dispensed with?

[03:38:02] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[03:38:20] Ayes 35, noes 0. Ayes 35, noes 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[03:38:39] I move that all those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the bills now on their second reading go by for the day? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[03:38:55] The bills will go by for the day. Supplemental calendar number two, uncontested calendar Senate bills on first reading. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move with all the Senate bills on first reading on the uncontested regular calendars on supplemental calendar number two pages one through two Senate bills 409 to 209 that the rules be suspended at the first constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with the question is shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars pages one through two Senate

[03:39:31] bill 409 through Senate bill 209 on supplemental calendar number two be dispensed with all in favor of that motion will say we'll record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do all do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 34 no zero eyes 34 no zero the reading of the titles is dispensed with senator from Eastern Fairfax that's all those bills goodbye for the day the question is shall the Senate bills on the uncontested and

[03:40:08] regular calendars now on their second reading go by for the day. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills will go by for the day. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. The inquiry of the clerk, does that complete this Friday calendar? Finally, yes. Good times. Is there any other

[03:40:39] business to come before the Senate? Senior Senator from Fairfax. Thank you madam president rise for an announcement senator has the floor what a wonderful weekend we are going to have searching for our checkbooks from the massey cancer center we started with a few drops we we increased to a trickle let's hope for a flood on monday thank you to all those who have contributed so far 250 dollars let's get it going we got the game next week thank you so

[03:41:10] much the clerk will report any announcements on the floor on the desk there may be a few on the the floor. Monday, February 16th, the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet at 8 a.m.

[03:41:28] Senate Room A, GAB. The Committee on Local Government will not meet. The Education and Health Subcommittee on Higher Education will not meet. The Democratic Caucus will meet 45 minutes before session in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol. The Republican Caucus will meet 30 minutes before session in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. And we don't have a weather report so it must be nice happy valentine's day the chair recognizes the senator from portsmouth

[03:42:02] thank you madam president madam president i move that the senate do now adjourn until 10 a.m on monday the question is shall the senate adjourn until 10 a.m on monday all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the senate stands adjourned until 10 a.m. on Monday.

[03:42:35] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:44:04] Senate chamber.

[03:45:08] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions,

[03:46:05] catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[03:46:11] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.